

GREENWOOD-SLIDELL VFD

FIREFIGHTER II

Lecture slides for the GSVFD Firefighter Taskbook

NFPA 1010 (2024) Chapter 7 · SFFMA Firefighter II · Modules 18–24

FROM TEAM MEMBER TO TEAM LEADER

Area	Firefighter I	Firefighter II
Supervision	Direct supervision	General supervision
Fireground	Works on a team	Leads an attack line, uses a thermal imager
Command	Works within ICS	Can take, run and transfer command
Rescue	Search and victim removal	Vehicle extrication, rescue team support
Prevention	Preserves evidence	Surveys, public education, preincident plans

Firefighter II: 7 modules, about 19 classroom hours and 30 drill hours.

MODULE 18

INCIDENT MANAGEMENT AND COMMUNICATIONS

Taskbook 2.1–2.3 | SFFMA FF II #1, #6 | 4 hr class · 2 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Decide when command is needed and establish it by radio
- Run the incident until an officer arrives, then transfer command
- Work in an assigned ICS role and request more resources
- Complete an accurate basic incident report

FIRST ON SCENE, NO OFFICER: YOU HAVE COMMAND

- Modes: investigating, fast attack, or command post
- Keep span of control at 3 to 7, ideally 5
- Assign arriving units; track accountability
- Ask early for a second alarm, mutual aid, tankers, extrication tools or rehab
- Transfer command face to face: conditions, actions, needs

INITIAL RADIO REPORT

1. Your unit on scene
2. Address
3. What you see: building, smoke, fire
4. What you are doing
5. Command name and mode

Example: "Engine 1 on scene, 123 County Road, single-story house, smoke showing, Engine 1 going offensive, County Road Command."

MODULE 19

FOAM, IGNITABLE LIQUIDS AND GAS CYLINDERS

Taskbook 2.4, 2.7 | SFFMA FF II #2, #3 | 3 hr class · 6 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Choose foam for hydrocarbon and polar-solvent fuels
- Set up an eductor system and make finished foam
- Build and hold a foam blanket, facing the hazard
- Control a flammable gas cylinder fire with a two-line team

FOAM: BUILD THE BLANKET, DON'T BREAK IT

How it works

Smothers, separates fuel from air, cools, and holds down vapors.

Pick the foam

Class A for ordinary fuels, Class B for liquids. Alcohol-resistant for polar solvents like ethanol blends.

PFAS

Fluorinated foams carry health risks. Use fluorine-free foam where possible; control exposure and runoff.

Proportioning

Eductor and nozzle flows must match. Mind hose length and elevation limits.

Application

Roll-on, bank-down or rain-down. Never plunge the stream into the fuel.

Face the hazard

Approach and retreat as a team, facing the spill, keeping the blanket intact.

GAS CYLINDER FIRES

SHUT OFF THE GAS BEFORE YOU PUT OUT THE FIRE

Extinguish the flame with gas still flowing and you have a vapor cloud waiting to ignite.

1. Identify the contents and pick a safe haven.
2. Two fog lines; approach from the side, never the ends.
3. Cool the cylinder, especially the vapor space at the top.
4. Close the valve under the fog curtain.
5. Watch for BLEVE signs: a loud relief valve, a bulging tank.
6. Back out facing the cylinder.

MODULE 20

LEADING THE ATTACK AND THERMAL IMAGING

Taskbook 2.5–2.6 | SFFMA FF II #4 · thermal imager not yet SFFMA-tested | 3 hr class · 6 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Lead an attack-line crew and pick the attack for the fire's location
- Coordinate with search and ventilation, and report to command
- Read building hazards and know when to pull out
- Use a thermal imager to find victims, hot spots and liquid levels

PICK THE ATTACK FOR WHERE THE FIRE IS

Attic

Fast spread over your head. Get water into the space from below.

Grade level

Control the door, cool the gases, advance to the seat of the fire.

Upper floors

Stairs as the attack route; protect them for everyone above.

Basement

Heat rises through you on the stairs; floors can fail. Consider an outside entrance.

Coordinate

Talk to the vent and search crews before you open up; keep the flow path in mind.

Report

Conditions, actions, needs. Keep command updated as things change.

Pull out

Sagging, cracking, rising heat with no progress: get your crew out and tell command.

THERMAL IMAGER: USES

- Scan a room for victims in heavy smoke
- Find the fire and its extension
- Find hot spots during overhaul
- Read the liquid level in a container
- Track your crew and your exit

LIMITS

- Shows surface heat only; it cannot see through walls, glass or water
- Shiny surfaces reflect heat and fool you
- Colors show relative heat, not safe temperatures
- Batteries die: keep crawling and feeling
- It never replaces a wall search or a hoseline

MODULE 21

FIRE CAUSE AND EVIDENCE PROTECTION

Taskbook 2.8 | SFFMA FF II #5 | 2 hr class · 2 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Tell origin from cause and read basic fire patterns
- Recognize signs that need an investigator
- Protect evidence until an investigator arrives
- Document what you saw, when, and who you told

NOTICE IT, PROTECT IT, REPORT IT

Why it matters

Cause drives prevention, prosecution and insurance. We are often the first to see the evidence.

Origin vs. cause

Origin is where it started. Cause is what started it. Find origin first.

Patterns

V-patterns, the lowest burn, and the deepest char point back toward the origin.

Red flags

Multiple origins, trailers, fuel containers, forced entry, odd odors, fire spreading too fast.

Protect

Leave it in place, cover it, tape off the area, and control who walks in.

Who investigates

Local or county fire marshal, the State Fire Marshal's Office, law enforcement, insurers.

MODULE 22

VEHICLE EXTRICATION AND RESCUE SUPPORT

Taskbook 2.9–2.11 | SFFMA FF II #12, #13 | 3 hr class · 8 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Size up a crash and control its hazards
- Stabilize the vehicle and manage glass
- Disentangle a victim with hand and power tools as a team
- Support technical rescue teams from outside the hazard

EXTRICATION IN ORDER

1 · Size up

Traffic, fuel, fire, number of vehicles and patients.

2 · Power down

Park, ignition off, key fob well away, 12-volt battery off.

3 · Stabilize

Chocks, cribbing and struts before anyone cuts.

4 · Glass

Protect the patient first; tempered breaks, laminated cuts.

5 · Disentangle

Doors, roof, dash lift or roll; hand off to EMS.

Vehicle hazards

Stay out of undeployed airbag zones. Watch seat-belt pretensioners and high-strength steel. Never cut orange high-voltage cables.

Rescue support

Rope, trench, confined space, collapse, water: set barriers and fetch tools. Do not enter without that training.

MODULE 23

FIRE AND LIFE SAFETY AND PREINCIDENT PLANNING

Taskbook 2.12–2.14 | SFFMA FF II #7, #9, #11 | 3 hr class · 3 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Do a fire safety survey in an occupied home
- Give fire safety information to a small group
- Prepare a preincident plan with an accurate sketch

PREVENT THE FIRE, PLAN FOR THE ONE YOU CAN'T

Home safety survey

- Get permission; walk through with the occupant
- Smoke alarms in every bedroom, outside sleeping areas, every level
- Heating clearances, cords, dryers, exits
- Recommend; refer unresolved issues

Public education

- Know the audience; keep it short
- Working smoke alarms
- A home escape plan
- Stop, drop and roll
- Answer or refer questions; document it

Preincident plan

- Construction, occupancy, contents
- Protection systems and utilities
- Hazards and access
- Nearest static water; tanker access
- Sketch with standard symbols

MODULE 24

POWER EQUIPMENT AND HOSE TESTING

Taskbook 2.15–2.16 | SFFMA FF II #8, #10 | 1 hr class · 3 hr drill

By the end of this module you can:

- Service and run generators, saws, fans and rescue tools
- Record maintenance and report problems
- Perform an annual fire hose service test safely
- Remove failed hose from service and record the results

POWER EQUIPMENT

- Check fuel and oil; clean filters
- Inspect blades and chains
- Run-test every unit
- Charge and rotate tool batteries
- Follow the manufacturer's manual
- Log it; report problems

ANNUAL HOSE TEST

1. Lay hose straight, within the test-length limit
2. Fill slowly and bleed out all air
3. Mark the hose behind each coupling
4. Raise pressure gradually; hold for the set time
5. Stand clear; never straddle the hose
6. Fail leaks, bulges, coupling slip; record every length

FIREFIGHTER II COMPLETE

NEXT STEPS

1. Every Phase 2 task signed at P
2. Training officer and trainee sign the completion page
3. Training uploaded to the SFFMA Portal
4. SFFMA Firefighter II written and skills exams

